

the Predator", March 10). Time is running out for the big cats and we should act now to save them.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Cine Trouble

One is surprised at the controversies surrounding *Jodha Akbar* considering the fact that most of us have grown up reading and hearing that Jodha Bai was Akbar's wife ("Romeo and Juliet in Rajasthan", March 3). The film is one of the greatest ever made in Bollywood.

SANJAY KAPOOR, *Delhi*

A growing culture of intolerance towards works of art and artists poses a threat to freedom of expression. We do have the right to express our dissatisfaction but within the parameters of law and order. Resorting to violence and vandalism is no solution.

PRIYANKA CHAUHAN, *Faridabad*

A film is a vehicle of entertainment. Education, if any, is an incidental by-product. No filmmaker seeks to make a Films Division documentary, linear in structure and covering all aspects of a subject. As such filmmakers should be given a free hand to film historical subjects without disruptions from lumpen elements like the Karni Sena.

NTIN SEN, *on e-mail*

Dark Cloud

The magazine has presented Badal Jr in a very good light ("Jet-Set Jathedar", March 3). But did it bother to investigate how he managed to get Rs 500 crore for his hospi-

ality business? In a country where thousands of farmers are under debt, how did a peasant's son manage to gather so much money?

JAGDEEP KAHLON, *Chandigarh*

All in the Mind

The article "Obsessive Compulsive Disorder" (March 3) was excellent. Thanks for giving such a good insight on the human mind and what ails it. Articles like this will benefit everyone immensely.

BALASUBRAMANIAN M., *Kuwait*

Street Smart

It came as a relief to know that the Bangalore Metropolitan Transport Corporation (BMTC) has woken up from its stupor and taken the first step in providing comfortable "mobility" to an average commuter ("Steering a Roadworthy Story", March 3). One hopes BMTC builds up on the good start and develops "alternative systems" of transport for the city.

SURABHI SITARAM, *Bangalore*

FOES MUST BECOME FRIENDS



Pakistan is in its most vulnerable position today and unless PPP and PML(N) sort out their differences by keeping national interest over politics, they may not be able to reclaim the role they deserve to play in the country's unfolding history ("Courting Crisis", March 10).

K.M.G. VIVEKANANDAM, *Madurai*

The judiciary will decide on President Musharraf's fate and it is hatred towards him that has resulted in the difference of opinions between PPP and PML(N). Such a development is quite unfortunate.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Nawaz Sharif and Asif Zardari should arrive at a democratic way to sort out their differences. The question should not be "who is right" but "what is right". Their country can expect at least this much from them.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, *Dehradun*

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Years Ago in India Today

APRIL 1-15, 1978



Mellowed Militancy

A spectre is haunting the Communist Party of India (Marxist)—the spectre of its militant proletarian past catching up with its mellowed middle-class present. The 14-year-old party finds itself confronted with a crisis of identity. Much has changed since the comrades last got together in Madurai in 1972.

According to the party, the most important change has been the overthrow of Jyoti Basu autocracy and the restoration of democracy. The party has won landslide victories in West Bengal and Tripura and made an impressive debut in Assam. This surfeit of success has been a coming of age for the party. Its revolutionary leaders of yore have now turned "respectable". "We never talked about armed revolution. We are not exactly like the Naxalites, who talk all sorts of foolish things which have nothing to do with Marxism," says Jyoti Basu, West Bengal chief minister.



—Ajay Singh

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